

Philipp Hilbert. *Senior Product Manager for modern B2B SaaS platforms.*

Positioning, Product manager with 13 years of regulated-industry and SaaS experience who ships end-to-end, builds with AI-native tools daily, and closes the loop between executive vision and engineering delivery.

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§ WHY MANIFEST

Manifest is building exactly the kind of platform that exposes the limits of conventional product management: broad surface area, nuanced real-world workflows, a B2B2C model that has to serve both the operator and the end guest, and a greenfield AI-native layer on top of an established booking and payments core. The job description calls out the Checkfront-lineage booking flow in the same breath as zero-to-one AI product work, two very different operating modes that require a PM who can switch between them without losing altitude. What makes this specific opportunity interesting is the explicit expectation that PMs use Claude, Cursor, and v0 to make ideas concrete before a single sprint starts; that is not a hiring-page aspiration at most companies, here it reads like a real team norm. *That is exactly the environment where my habit of running cheap experiments before expensive builds compounds into visible output.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo exploration and spec generation
- **Cursor**, AI-assisted editing across codebases
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end prototyping before dev handoff
- **GitHub Copilot**, inline code and test scaffolding

- **Framer**, interaction and flow mockups
 - **Gamma.app**, async product briefs and discovery decks
 - **GPT**, ideation, edge-case generation, release notes
 - **n8n**, agentic workflow design and LLM orchestration
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§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, Dagster, dbt, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro, Matomo, MicroStrategy, Shopware.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/hilbertp) →

A zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace that takes the headhunter out of construction staffing.

- Matches construction firms with workers through WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, no app install barrier.
 - Anonymity-until-payment model protects both sides until commitment, eliminating the free-rider problem common in staffing platforms.
 - LLM agents handle funnel automation end-to-end so one person runs the full day-to-day operation.
 - Directly relevant to Manifest's B2B2C model: same challenge of designing for two audiences with opposed incentives inside a single transaction flow.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT MANIFEST

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow customer-facing teams and support tickets to map where the booking, payments, and operations workflows break down for tour operators, before touching the roadmap.

WEEK 2

Prototype, validate fast.

Use Lovable or v0 to turn the top two friction points from week 1 into clickable flows, then put them in front of two or three customers before writing a single spec.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Lock scope for the first milestone, define the success metric up front, and work the delivery sequence with engineering until the first increment is out and numbers are moving.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Manifest team,

I have spent the last thirteen years shipping product in environments where getting the workflow wrong has real consequences: defence AI for a multinational programme, a national labour-market analytics platform used by policymakers, a claims system for insurers, and a mobile patient app in hospitals. In each case the job was the same: turn messy, ambiguous operational reality into clear product direction, then stay close enough to engineering to make sure what ships actually solves the problem. That track record maps directly onto what Manifest's job description calls for, a PM who owns direction and delivery, not just the backlog.

What specifically drew me to this role is the combination of an established booking and payments core alongside a fast-moving AI-native layer. That is not a common architecture, and it creates a genuinely interesting product challenge: the operator workflows in tours and activities are intricate and unforgiving, missed booking, wrong capacity, broken payment, while the AI-native website platform on top needs the kind of zero-to-one speed that tolerates ambiguity. I have operated in both modes. At Rohde & Schwarz I owned an AI and data platform for a multinational engineering programme, running a 15-person cross-functional team through GitOps delivery and cutting rollout time from days to 30 minutes. At CLINET Platforms I took a five-person team facing an undeliverable roadmap, cut it to the highest-value 10 percent, and watched user acceptance rise more than fivefold. Both required the same discipline: agree what success looks like before building, then prove whether it happened.

On the AI-native tooling front, this is not a posture for me, it is how I work. I use Claude Code daily for in-repo exploration and spec generation, Lovable and Framer for rapid prototyping before dev handoff, n8n for agentic workflow design, and Cursor for editing across codebases. In my construct8 side project I built a two-sided B2B2C marketplace from zero using LLM agents to run the full funnel so that one person could operate it. When Manifest's description says PMs

are expected to use Claude, Cursor, and v0 to make ideas concrete before implementation, I read that as a description of my default workflow, not a new skill to acquire.

The SaaS platform surface at Manifest, booking flows, ecommerce, payments, accounting, operations, and now AI-native website delivery, is broad, and I understand why you are hiring more than one PM to cover it. My strongest fit is likely where transaction-heavy workflows meet technical depth: booking and payments logic, acceptance criteria for edge cases in complex flows, and collaboration with front-end engineers on interaction details and product polish. I have shipped a Shopware B2B procurement webshop for AOK, owned payment flow architecture at Kvitt (acquired by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem), and designed P2P payment UX at scale. That foundation transfers directly to the operational and ecommerce layers of Manifest's platform.

I would welcome the chance to talk through where my background fits best across the areas you are hiring for. I am available at four weeks' notice and happy to provide references from any of the roles above.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Senior Product Manager with 13 years of end-to-end product ownership in B2B SaaS, regulated industries, and founder-stage environments. Owns roadmap, prioritisation, and delivery across complex transactional workflows, booking flows, payments, operations, and analytics platforms, while staying close enough to engineering to shape technically nuanced, UI-heavy product areas. Fluent in AI-native tooling as a daily practice, not a talking point.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, PoC, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, product lifecycle management, go-to-market support.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI (XAI); full prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable, Framer.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, definition of done, epics, backlog refinement, sprint planning, story-point estimation, velocity and burndown, release planning, UAT, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Agile, Scrum, Kanban, SAFe (Scaled Agile Framework), ART (agile release train), PI (program increment) planning.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, ArgoCD, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Stakeholder and Leadership: cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution, change management.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership, ROI reasoning.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI AND DATA PLATFORM 2024-2025

Led a 15-person cross-functional team delivering an internal AI and data platform for the FCAS European programme; cut GitOps rollout time from days to 30 minutes via ArgoCD, and increased pipeline runs 200% by redirecting strategy from UI-led to developer-code-first design based on instrumented workflow analysis.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023-2024

Owned a national labour-market analytics SaaS platform for policymakers and researchers; introduced Dagster and dbt to cut quarterly data-update time by 75%, integrated test automation into Jenkins, and carried a full UI relaunch and ETL migration concurrently. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut an undeliverable roadmap to its top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Shipped a CGM hospital information system (KIS) interface that reduced digital anamnesis time from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total exodus to a single departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production and cut time-to-market for new insurance products from months to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER · RETAIL PAYMENTS AND POS 2021-2022

Moved research results into production across a matrix organisation in a fully SAFe setup with agile release trains and PI planning; domain: retail, payments, POS and forecourt systems.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · PRODUCT OWNER (INTERIM) · GOVERNMENT DATA PLATFORM 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2019-2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production. Backlog refinement, user stories, and acceptance criteria in Jira.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY IT 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end across wind-energy operations.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE 2017-2018

Wifi infrastructure rollout across nine hospitals in a clinical network.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PRODUCT MANAGER · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING B2B2C 2025-2026

Zero-to-one two-sided marketplace; anonymity-until-payment model, WhatsApp and Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel. Funnel and conversion analysis in SQL.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE ENCRYPTION 2016-2021

Shipped a three-layer quantum-secure encryption product that installs in under two minutes; owned backup, restore, and data-encryption architecture. Later Chair of the Board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018-2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds, owning financial planning and investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013-2018

Built a mobile group-based P2P payments product from zero; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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TRUE NORTH · APPLICATION PACKAGE · CHECKFRONT

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